



Booked Worm

A reading tracker for people who read too many books at once

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jeirld.github.io/BookedWorm

The problem

- I read several books at once and lose track of where I left off.
- Notes end up scattered across my phone, in margins, or nowhere.
- I wanted one place that answers: what am I reading, what did I finish, what did I drop, and what did I think?

Four statuses

Want to read

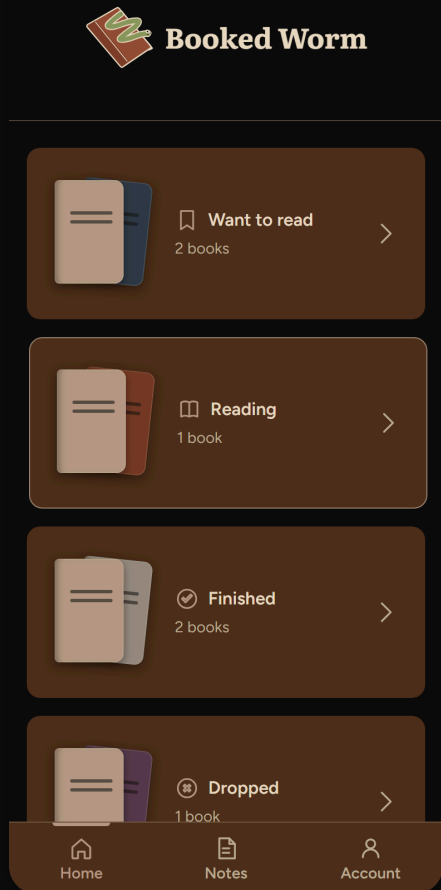
Reading

Finished

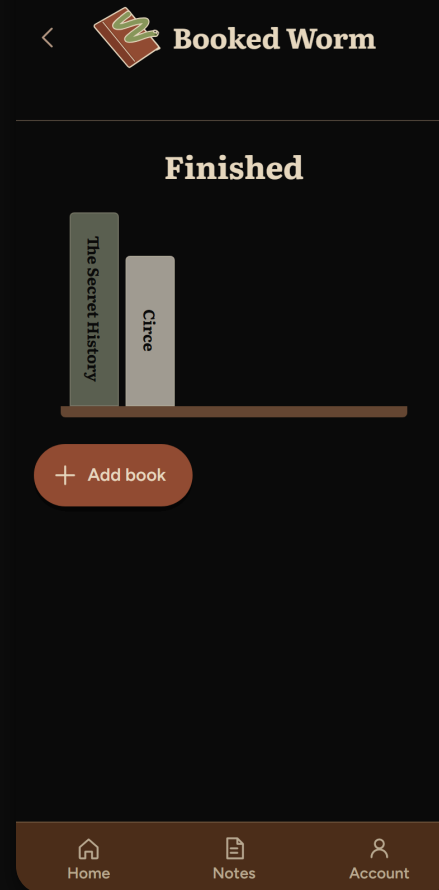
Dropped

Each has an icon and a word, so it never depends on colour alone.

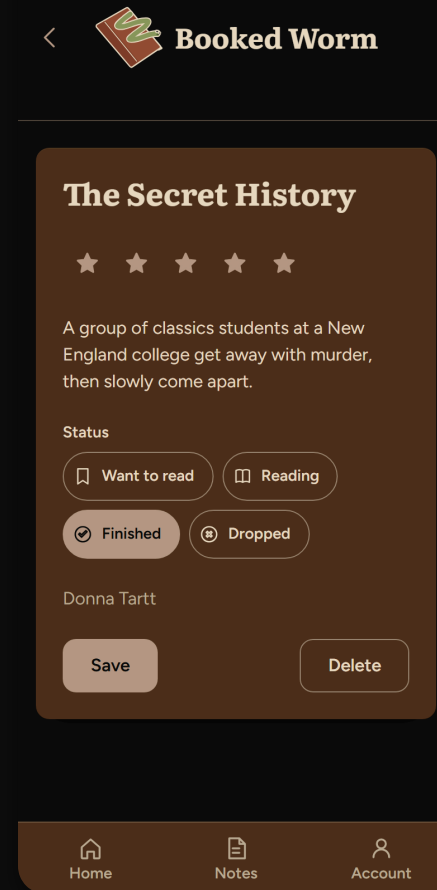
Demo



Home: one row per status



Shelf: books as spines



Book: rating, status, delete

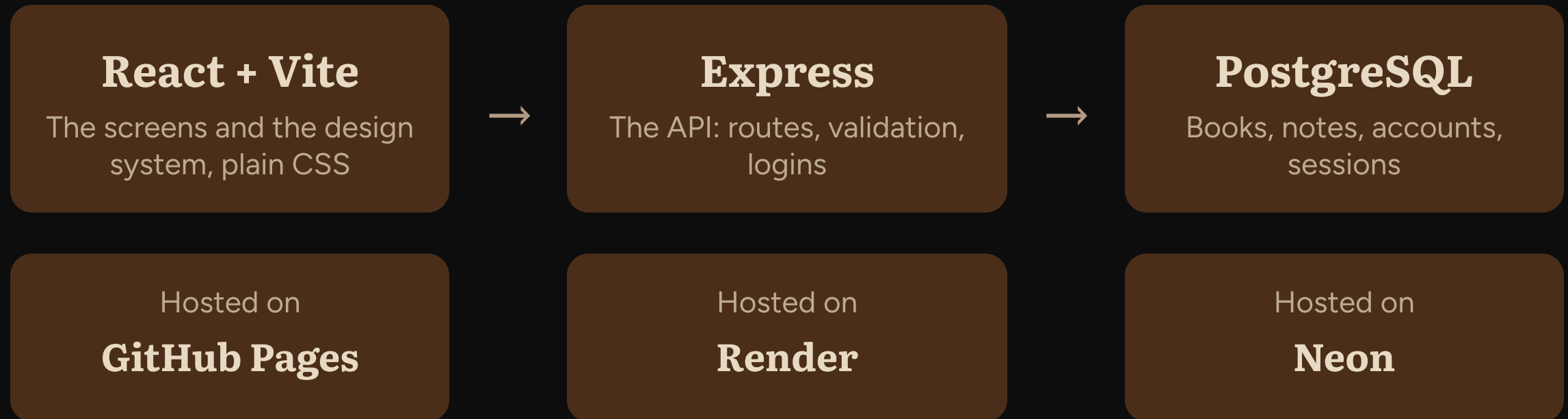
Also in the app

Search, notes tied to a book

Accounts, private libraries, delete account

Live demo: [bookworm](#)

The tech



- Every SQL query is parameterised, and every query is scoped to the logged-in person.
- Passwords are salted bcrypt hashes, and login tokens are stored only as hashes.
- helmet, rate limiting, server-side validation, CORS limited to my site.

Challenges

Blank page after deploying

GitHub Pages serves the site from `/BookedWorm/`, and my build and router did not know that. Fixed the base path.

Dates would have crashed React

The database driver returns dates as objects, which React cannot print. Caught by testing before deploying.

Security gaps

My checklist found no helmet, a critical dependency advisory, and errors returned as 500s. Fixed and retested.

Where the AI got it wrong

It called the site ready before loading it from the real path, and the title was cut off on phones. Details in `AI-USAGE.md`.

What I would do next

- Password change and reset, which needs email or cookies.
- Automated tests for the API, so I do not retest by hand.
- Sort on the shelves.
- A database user with only the permissions the app needs.

What I learned

Build the backend in small steps, test each one against a real database, and run the security checklist while building, not at the end.